

A HOTPAST STORY

I KNOW WHO YOU DID LAST SUMMER

BOOK 1



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I Know Who You Did Last Summer Book 1

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Paul Garland



Cerulean Erotica

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Chapter One

Emmie stood in front of the wardrobe, wearing just her lacy black underwear, still trying to make up her mind. Her hair, golden blonde waves that fell just past her shoulders, shimmered in the low light as she absentmindedly ran a hand through it. I leaned against the edge of the bed, pretending to still be searching for my shirt, but in reality, my attention was on her. It always was.

She had that look about her, the kind that made me feel like I was lucky to have her in my life. Maybe even too lucky. It was eight years since we first got together, teenage sweethearts and during all that time, the thought hadn't quite left me—me, an ordinary guy, somehow landing a girl like Emmie. I watched her through the reflection in the mirror, her curves highlighted by the room's soft light. Her bra clung to her busty frame, her hips curved in a way that always had my eyes lingering more than I should.

"You still haven't decided what to wear?" I teased, half-heartedly flicking through some hangers. I could've just grabbed any old shirt, but this was more fun.

Emmie turned, holding up a little black dress, the one that hugged her in all the right places. "How about this?" she asked, giving me a little grin. "Does this say 'nice to meet you, Luke's new girlfriend'?"

I chuckled. "It says you'll freeze your arse off. It's bloody autumn, Em."

She pouted, but I knew she wasn't going to argue. I could tell from her face that she'd wear it anyway. "But I really want to wear it," she sighed, "Fine. I'll grab a jacket."

She tossed the dress onto the bed, still deliberating in front of the mirror. We were supposed to be meeting Luke and Natasha tonight—the first time we’d seen my best friend with anyone serious in years. Normally, Luke was the type to keep things light; his happy-go-lucky nature made him in no rush to settle down with anyone, even though he was in his late twenties, like me. So him introducing his new girlfriend, Natasha, to us felt like a big deal. I was curious, of course, but Emmie... she was more than curious. I could tell.

While she slipped into her dress, my mind wandered. It was hard to believe it had been almost a year since we got back together. A year since I’d packed up my stuff from the flat I’d endured for just over a year, and moved back into this house that we’d bought together. Thinking back to that time still made my stomach twist in knots. We were married five years before the split, and dated for a year before that, but something had shifted along the way. Between Emmie’s long hours at the law firm where she worked and caring for her sick father, we’d become strangers in our own home. She wasn’t ready for the family I wanted, wasn’t ready to slow down. I’d pushed her, wanting her to choose me over everything else. Looking back now, I knew I’d been wrong to give her that ultimatum.

She asked me for more time, a year to sort everything out. But I didn’t listen. Things got heated, tempers frayed. We’d argued and in the end, I left, disillusioned and lost.

Now, here we were, almost a year back together, and stronger than ever. We’d been talking about starting fresh, maybe renewing our vows, and finally thinking about that family I’d been so eager for. Emmie’s father had passed away during the year we spent apart – and she’d changed her job – so life felt totally different now. All our troubles felt so far behind us, and yet, sometimes, I’d catch a glimpse of the past arguments in her eyes—something she wasn’t saying, something left unspoken. Our relationship still needed a little work, and some extra attention, but no marriage was perfect. Ultimately, Emmie and I loved each other. It’d taken us a year apart to fully realise that but we wouldn’t make the same mistake again.

“Can you grab me a jacket?” Emmie’s voice broke into my thoughts. “Something that will go with my dress.”

I moved towards the wardrobe again and started rummaging around, pushing aside some coats and jackets that hadn’t seen daylight in ages. “Which one are you after?”

“That green one, the old one I haven’t worn in forever,” she said, already distracted as she slipped into the black dress, adjusting the straps in the mirror after smoothing it down over her hips.

I found it, buried behind some of my jackets. As I pulled it out, a faint smell of perfume clung to it like it hadn’t been worn in a long while. I tossed it onto the bed, not thinking much of it. “Here you go.”

Emmie glanced at it. “God, I haven’t worn that since... well, I don’t even remember when.” She smiled at me, then turned back to her reflection.

I went back to my search for a shirt but was stopped by the soft sound of something hitting the floor. Two small wrappers had slipped out of the jacket’s pocket, landing just beside my feet. I bent down, picking one up, my chest tightening as I recognised what it was—a condom wrapper.

“What the hell is this?” I muttered, standing there, holding it up.

Emmie turned towards me, the colour draining from her face. Her eyes widened, her lips parting slightly as if she was about to say something, but no words came out. I could see the gears turning in her head, like she was trying to figure out how to explain this.

“Huh?” she finally said, her voice barely above a whisper, “That’s weird... I don’t know how that got there.”

I raised an eyebrow, feeling a surge of disbelief. “It was in your jacket pocket. You don’t know how it got there?”

She walked around the bed, bending to pick up the second wrapper, looking at it like she’d never seen it before.

“I’m confused.” Emmie stood there, holding the wrapper in her hand, still staring at it like it might somehow disappear if she focused hard enough. “These were in the jacket?”

I could see the way her mind was working, trying to piece together an explanation, something that would put an end to this before it even started.

“Yes,” I nodded. “Would you care to explain how they got there?”

“I swear, Ryan, I haven’t worn this jacket in ages,” she said, her voice light, almost dismissive. “Honestly, I don’t even remember the last time I put it on.”

“Maybe you wore it when we weren’t... you know... together?” I offered, my voice calm, but firm.

Her hazel eyes darted to mine, just for a second, before quickly looking away. She turned back to the mirror, fussing with the straps of her dress again. “I... I don’t think so,” she said, her tone casual, like she was already

trying to move past it. “I mean, I guess it’s possible, but... I really don’t remember. Maybe I just left them in there from forever ago. It’s not important.”

I frowned, stepping closer. “Emmie, come on. You really don’t remember? Two condom wrappers don’t just end up in your jacket pocket by accident.”

She stayed quiet, biting her lip. I could tell she was trying to figure out a way to dodge this, but I wasn’t going to let it slide.

“Emmie,” I said softly, trying not to sound accusatory, “You told me that there wasn’t anyone else during the time we weren’t together. But if something did happen...” I swallowed, feeling the words catch in my throat.

My wife sighed, turning to face me fully. There was something in her eyes, a mix of guilt and frustration, like she knew this was a conversation she couldn’t avoid any longer but hated that it was happening. “Ryan...” she started, her voice low, “It doesn’t matter, okay? It was... it was during our break. We weren’t together. What difference does it make now?”

I stared at her, my heart pounding in my chest. “So, there was someone else then?”

She hesitated, her gaze flickering to the floor before she nodded slowly. “Not really, but... Yeah... I slept with someone.” Her voice was barely above a whisper.

The words hit me like a punch to the gut, even though I’d half-expected them. I knew she was right. We were separated. I had no right to be angry, not really. But that didn’t stop the knot forming in my stomach.

“Who was it?” I asked, my voice steadier than I felt.

Emmie shifted uncomfortably, crossing her arms over her breasts, her posture defensive. “It doesn’t matter, Ryan. I don’t even remember it. I was drunk. It was just... a one-off thing. Some guy I met at a bar.”

“A one-night stand?” I struggled to believe that. One-night stands just weren’t Emmie’s thing. “What was his name?”

She shrugged, shaking her head as if she didn’t remember.

I stayed silent, processing her body language as she turned away again to look at herself in the mirror. Her cheeks were burning red and she was trembling slightly. The idea that she couldn’t even remember the guy’s name gnawed at me. I didn’t know if that made it better or worse.

“You didn’t get his name?” I asked, a rough laugh escaping my throat. “You fucked a total stranger?”

“No... I... His name was... Shaun, I think?”

I narrowed my eyes slightly. “You think?”

She winced, realising how weak that sounded. “Yeah, Shaun. I’m pretty sure that was his name. It was... one of those nights, you know? I was with Jen. I was upset and drunk and wasn’t thinking straight, and I didn’t even plan for it to happen. It just did. I’ve tried to forget about it ever since.”

“And you never thought to tell me?” I asked quietly, more hurt than angry now.

Emmie sighed, running a hand through her hair. “No, because it didn’t mean anything, Ryan. It was just a mistake. We weren’t together at the time. We’d broken up. When we got back together, I didn’t want to bring it up and hurt you. I love you. That’s all that matters. This... this doesn’t change anything.”

I swallowed, trying to keep my emotions in check. She wasn’t wrong. But still... “You said it was just once, right?”

Emmie’s eyes flickered again, and I could see the uncertainty creeping back in. “Yeah... just once.” But the way she said it—like she was trying to convince herself as much as me—made my stomach twist.

I wanted to believe her. I really did. But something about the way she was avoiding eye contact, the way her voice wavered, told me there was more she wasn’t saying.

“Is that the only time?” I asked, my voice barely above a whisper.

Emmie’s jaw tightened, and she turned to face me, her hands fiddling with the edge of the black dress. “Ryan... we were separated. You left me. I begged you not to go but you did. So, what I did during that time... it’s not important. What matters is that we found each other again. We worked through our issues. We’re stronger now because of it.”

I stared at her, my mind racing. She was deflecting, trying to push past this before I could dig any deeper. And maybe she was right. Maybe knowing every detail wouldn’t help. But that didn’t stop the nagging feeling in the back of my mind, the gnawing curiosity that wouldn’t let this go.

“Emmie, I just... I need to know,” I said, my voice hoarse. “Was it just the one time? Or were there others?”

She turned back to me, her expression pleading. “Ryan, please... don’t do this. It’s not going to help. What we did during that time doesn’t matter.

We're here now. We're together. That's all that should matter."

I swallowed hard, feeling the weight of her words. Maybe she was right. Maybe I was digging into something that didn't need to be unearthed. But the idea that she could have been with someone else, that there might be more to this than she was letting on, ate away at me.

She stepped closer, placing a hand on my chest. "I love you, Ryan," she whispered, her voice soft but firm. "I've always loved you. That never changed, not even when we were apart. Please... let's not drag this up. Let's focus on us, on our future. We've come so far, don't let this pull us back."

I looked into her eyes, seeing the sincerity there. She meant it. She loved me. I knew that. She was right. What mattered was our future. We were planning to start a family and take our love for each other to the next level. Maybe even renew our vows.

"It was a one-time thing," Emmie repeated, taking my hands in hers. She must have seen the look of doubt on my face, the hurt she'd inadvertently caused. "Just leave it there, okay? I made a dumb, drunken mistake. I'm sorry you had to find out this way but Ryan? I love you."

I nodded slowly, feeling the tension in my chest start to ease—if only a little. Emmie had always been good at talking me down and making sense of things when I felt like everything was spiralling out of control. Maybe I was overreacting, maybe I needed to let it go, just like she was saying. After all, we were stronger now. We'd been through worse and come out the other side.

"Alright," I said, my voice quieter than I intended. "I love you too."

Emmie's expression softened, her lips curving into a relieved smile. "And that's all that matters," she whispered, stepping closer and brushing her lips against mine in a soft, lingering kiss. "Now, let's get going before Luke thinks we've ditched them."

She took the condom wrapper from my hand and together with the one she held, tossed them into the bin with a casualness I couldn't quite mirror. I watched her for a moment, trying to shake the knot that had settled in my stomach.

I took a deep breath, trying to clear my head and found the shirt I'd been half-heartedly searching for earlier. I slid it on, buttoning it up as I glanced at Emmie one last time before stepping in front of the mirror to fix my hair. She was fiddling with her earrings, humming quietly to herself, the tension

in the room all but dissipated. But as much as I wanted to, I couldn't entirely push away the weight of what I'd just found out.

Emmie might have put it behind her, but I wasn't sure if I could do the same. The idea of her with someone else, even if it was a mistake and the fact she'd kept it from me, made my chest tighten. But I swallowed it down. There wasn't time for this. Not tonight.

"We good to go?" she asked, slipping on her heels and grabbing her purse.

"Yeah," I said, forcing a smile. "We should head out before Luke gives me grief for making them wait."

"And we finally get to meet the mysterious Natasha," Emmie grinned. "Let's go and see what's so special about her."

Chapter Two

We'd barely sat down at the table when Luke flashed us a grin, his arm draped casually around Natasha's shoulders. The restaurant was cosy, with candle-lit tables and dark wooden beams that gave it a warm, intimate atmosphere. The kind of place that looked as if it had been there for decades, quietly tucked away in the neighbourhood near my old flat — the one I'd rented during our split. The scent of roasted meats and fresh herbs filled the air, and I could already see from the menu that the food would be excellent.

Luke was in his element, clearly proud to introduce Natasha to us. I hadn't seen him this excited in a long time, not since we were teenagers when he'd had that wide-eyed crush on a girl from school — what was her name again? Gabbie, that was it. He'd followed her around for weeks.

It was rare to see him so serious about anyone these days. Normally, he'd stick to casual flings, keeping things fun and light, but Natasha... well, from the way his hand stayed firmly on her shoulder and the way he kept sneaking glances at her, I could tell this was different.

"Guys," Luke said, beaming as he turned his attention to us. "Let's do this officially... I'd like you to meet Natasha."

I smiled, leaning in a little. "Nice to finally meet you, Natasha. Luke's been going on about you for weeks. We were starting to think you were a myth."

Natasha laughed softly, her lips parting into a shy smile that lit up her whole face. She was strikingly beautiful — dark hair that cascaded down

her back like silk, skin like smooth porcelain, and lips painted a deep red. Her eyes were large, almond-shaped, a piercing shade of green that seemed to glow in the dim light. There was something elegant about the way she carried herself, confident yet soft. The kind of beauty that made you glance twice.

“It’s really nice to meet you both,” she said, her voice melodic and calm. She gave Emmie a longer look, as though sizing her up, before her gaze finally settled back on me. “Luke’s told me so much about you two.”

I nodded, but my eyes lingered on her for a moment longer than I intended. Something about her seemed familiar, like I’d seen her somewhere before.

“Have we met before?” I asked, leaning forward slightly, studying her face more closely. “You look really familiar to me.”

For the briefest moment, her expression faltered — just enough to catch my attention. There was a flicker of something, hesitation maybe, in her eyes before she smiled again, more controlled this time.

“I don’t think so,” she said, shaking her head lightly, though she didn’t sound entirely certain. “But then again, I meet a lot of people through work. Maybe we’ve crossed paths somewhere.”

“Huh,” I murmured, glancing at Luke, who was too wrapped up in his own world to notice the odd exchange.

Natasha’s smile didn’t waver, but there was a hint of something else behind it — something I couldn’t quite place. Emmie shifted beside me, glancing between us with mild interest, but she didn’t say anything, just gave me a soft nudge with her elbow, as if to remind me we were here to enjoy dinner, not interrogate Luke’s new girlfriend.

“So, how long have you two been together?” Emmie asked, picking up the thread of conversation to keep things moving. Her tone was light, but I could see the glint of curiosity in her hazel eyes. She had that way about her — always wanting to know more, always digging for the details.

Luke grinned, clearly happy to be on the receiving end of the attention. “A few months now,” he said, squeezing Natasha’s shoulder. “But it feels like we’ve known each other for ages, doesn’t it?”

Natasha nodded, her smile softening as she looked at him. “Yeah, it does.” She gave him a look I’d seen Emmie give me countless times — affectionate, but with something deeper beneath it. Something like

gratitude. “We actually met quite by chance,” she added. “It was kind of... serendipitous.”

“How so?” My wife asked, her curiosity piqued.

“We were both at a bar — Luke was there to meet you.” Her eyes flicked back to me and once again, I couldn’t shake the feeling that there was more to the story than she was letting on. But for now, it wasn’t my place to dig. Not yet, anyway.

“But you didn’t show, do you remember?” Luke continued for her. “You had some sort of work emergency or something.”

I did remember. I was working the out-of-hours service and a call came through at the last minute, leading me to cancel my weekly meet-up with Luke.

“Anyway, I was on a blind date and the guy didn’t show,” Natasha said, smiling at Luke and he grinned back, obviously enamoured with the story. “We got talking at the bar, just two stood-up people looking for someone to have a drink with — “

“And look at us now,” Luke finished for. “It was fate.”

I nodded along with Luke’s recount of how they met, but my attention kept drifting back to Natasha. There was something in the way she watched Emmie — curiosity mixed with a faint hint of admiration. Or maybe I was reading too much into it. She’d just said they’d been together a few months, and Luke looked happy, more than I’d seen him in a long time, so maybe this was just her way of getting to know us. Still, it made me uneasy in a way I couldn’t quite explain.

Emmie didn’t seem to notice anything off, though. She was already diving into a conversation with Luke about her new job, her voice animated as he asked about the new project she was working on. I sat back, taking a sip of my drink, trying to relax and hoping that the whole night wasn’t just Luke and Natasha gazing into each other’s eyes all night like a couple of lovesick teenagers.

“So, how long have you two been back together?” Natasha asked suddenly, her voice cutting through my thoughts. She glanced from me to Emmie, her green eyes alight with interest. “Luke told me you’d been through a split but now...”

Emmie smiled and shrugged lightly. “We’ve been back together coming up to a year now. We had a bit of a rocky patch,” she said, keeping her tone light, but I could sense the shift in her posture. It was subtle, but I knew

Emmie well enough to recognise when she was steering the conversation, trying to avoid diving too deep. “But we’re stronger for it now.”

Luke shot me a look, something halfway between sympathy and tact, like he was weighing up whether or not to say something. He’d been there for me through the worst of it, offering up his couch after I moved out, until I managed to find a flat. He knew how much it had sucked to be apart from Emmie, even if he didn’t know all the details.

“Yeah?” Natasha leaned in slightly, her gaze now fixed firmly on Emmie. “I mean, I don’t want to pry, but how did you guys... you know, make it work again? Most couples who split don’t get back together. It must have been really hard.”

Emmie’s eyes flicked to me for a second, just a quick glance before she turned back to Natasha. “It wasn’t easy,” she admitted, keeping her smile, though I could see the tension forming in her jaw. “We just... took the time we needed to figure things out, and in the end, we both wanted the same thing: to give our marriage a second chance and make it work, no matter what it takes.”

Natasha nodded thoughtfully, but her eyes didn’t leave Emmie’s face. “That’s really admirable. It must take a lot to put the past behind you.” She said it with such casualness, but there was an edge to it, a hint that she was pushing for something deeper. Emmie shifted in her seat, the lightness in her tone fading just a touch.

“Yeah, well, the past is the past,” Emmie replied, her voice a little tighter now. “What matters is that we found our way back to each other.”

I felt Emmie’s hand slide into mine under the table, a small squeeze to anchor herself. It was a subtle move, but it told me all I needed to know. Natasha was pushing buttons, and Emmie wasn’t having it. I could tell this was one of those moments where Emmie would shut down if it went any further, so I cut in.

“We’re just glad to be back on track,” I said, glancing at Natasha before shifting the conversation. “We just want to move forward now.”

“Speaking of moving forward,” Emmie’s lips curved into a smile, though it was slightly hesitant at first. “We’ve been talking about starting a family.”

Luke grinned. “Wow, big news! I’m glad to hear it, mate,” he said, clapping me on the shoulder. “You’ll make a great dad one day.”

“Thanks,” I mumbled, trying to keep my smile steady, even though my mind was racing. We hadn’t exactly sat down and planned it all out. Sure,

we'd talked about having kids eventually, but I wasn't expecting Emmie to announce it over dinner.

"Wow, Emmie," Natasha said, her eyes wide. "That's amazing. You must be so excited. Do you feel ready for it?"

Emmie smiled, but there was a slight hesitation before she replied. "Yeah, I think so. It's something we've been talking about for a while now."

I glanced at her, trying to gauge how much of that was true. It wasn't that I doubted she wanted it, but something felt... off. Maybe it was the timing. Maybe it was the way she'd so casually tossed the idea out in front of our friends before we'd even fully mapped it out ourselves. Was she trying to outdo the couple opposite us somehow? Or prove something to them?

"Well, good luck. I'm sure you'll be great parents," Natasha added, smiling at Emmie, though I noticed how her eyes lingered a bit too long.

The rest of the evening moved on smoothly after that, with Luke diving into tales of his own latest project at work, and Emmie steering the conversation into safer territory. But I couldn't shake the feeling that Natasha had been digging for something more, and the way she looked at Emmie made me feel like she knew more than she was letting on.

As the night drew to a close, and we said our goodbyes outside the restaurant, Luke gave me one last slap on the back before pulling Natasha in closer. "We should do this again," he said, flashing us both a grin. "Now that things are, you know... getting serious — maybe — with Natasha, it's about time we hung out more often, all four of us."

"Definitely," I agreed, though my mind was still tangled in thoughts of everything that had happened tonight. Emmie's announcement, Natasha's interest in our relationship — it all swirled in my head, refusing to settle.

Emmie was quiet on the drive back, lost in her thoughts. But when we got home, she turned to me with that look — the one that told me she had something on her mind, but something she wasn't quite ready to talk about.

"Are you okay?" I asked gently, as I kicked off my shoes and Emmie slipped out of the jacket that the condom wrappers had fallen out of earlier. "Tonight was fun, don't you think?"

Instead of replying, she stepped close, pressing her body against mine as she reached up and kissed me passionately, pinning me against the wall in the hallway. "Let's go to bed," she whispered, her hands already slipping under my shirt, tracing the lines of my chest. "I've been thinking about you all night."

The shift was so sudden, that I almost didn't have time to process it. One minute, we were standing in the hallway, still winding down from the evening out, and the next, Emmie was pulling me towards the bedroom, her lips urgent and her hands more eager than usual. Something about it felt... different. She was using sex as a distraction. I knew it, and she probably knew I knew it too. But I wasn't going to stop her. Not yet.

I followed her into the bedroom, my thoughts still tangled with everything that had happened tonight, but Emmie's lips were on mine before I could say another word, guiding me towards the bed, her body pressing into me with a sudden intensity that caught me off guard. The dim street light glowing through the open curtains cast shadows over her face, highlighting the curve of her cheekbones and the delicate lines of her jaw as she kissed me with an urgency I hadn't felt in a while. Her fingers slid under my shirt, her nails dragging lightly over my skin, sending shivers down my spine.

I didn't waste any time, my hands already moving to the zipper of her dress, tugging it down her back. The thin fabric slipped easily from her shoulders, falling to the floor in a soft heap, leaving her in just her black lace bra and matching panties. My breath hitched in my throat at the sight of her — the curves of her body, her skin glowing in the dim light of our bedroom, the tension from dinner fading away as something more primal took over.

She stepped back slightly, her hands moving to unbutton my shirt with quick, nimble fingers, her eyes never leaving mine. Each touch felt electric, sparking a heat that radiated through my chest. I tugged the shirt over my head, tossing it aside, and before I could say a word, she was back, her hands at my belt, unbuckling it with the same urgency, her lips finding my neck, trailing soft, wet kisses along my collarbone.

"I need you," she whispered, her voice low and breathy, as she pulled the belt free and undid my trousers. Her fingers brushed against me through the fabric, teasing, just enough to make my cock twitch in anticipation.

I stepped out of my trousers, and in the next moment, we were on the bed, her body beneath mine as I hovered over her, taking in the sight of her lying there, her chest rising and falling with quickened breaths. Her blonde hair spilled out onto the pillow, framing her flushed face, her hazel eyes dark with want. I could feel her hips arching towards me, her legs parting just enough to let me know she wanted this just as badly as I did.

I leaned down, capturing her lips again, my hands sliding down her sides, feeling the softness of her skin beneath my palms. I reached behind her, unclasping her bra and pulling it free, revealing the fullness of her large breasts, her dark pink nipples already hard, straining against the cool air. She moaned softly as I cupped them, rolling her nipples between my fingers.

“Ryan...” she breathed, her voice a plea, her hands pulling me closer, her legs wrapping around my waist.

I kissed her neck, then lower, trailing down to her breasts, sucking one of her nipples into my mouth as my hand moved between her thighs, pressing against the damp fabric of her panties. She was already soaked, and the feeling of her heat against my hand made my pulse quicken. I tugged at the waistband, pulling them down her legs, revealing the soft, smooth skin of her shaved pussy, her slit wet and glistening.

I slid my fingers between her folds, teasing her clit with slow, deliberate circles, watching as her head fell back against the pillow, her lips parting in a breathless moan. Her hips bucked against my hand, and I could feel the tension in her body building.

“Don’t stop,” she whispered, her voice barely audible, her eyes half-closed, lost in the sensation.

I pulled back, just enough to position myself between her legs, my cock hard and throbbing as I lined up with her entrance. The thought of another man being where I was now, touching her like this, with one of the condoms from her pocket snug on his cock, flashed through my mind, but I pushed it away. This was us — this was our moment. I needed to focus on her, on us.

I entered her slowly, watching her face as her body welcomed me, her breath catching in her throat as I slid deeper. Her nails dug into my back, her legs tightening around me as I began to move, slow at first, our bodies finding their rhythm, the heat between us growing with every thrust.

“Fuck, Em,” I groaned, burying my face in the crook of her neck, the scent of her skin filling my senses, intoxicating. I could feel her nails raking down my back, the sound of her breathless moans urging me on, pushing me deeper, harder.

“Yes,” she gasped, her hips meeting mine with each thrust, her body trembling beneath me. “Just like that... don’t stop...”

I kissed her again, harder this time, my tongue sliding against hers as I quickened my pace, the sound of our bodies coming together filling the room as she thrust her hips upwards to meet me. I could feel her tightening around my cock, her walls clenching as her orgasm built, her moans growing louder, more desperate.

“I won’t take long to cum...” she whimpered, her hands gripping the sheets, her body arching off the bed.

I thrust into her hard and fast, unable to contain my excitement at such passionate, spontaneous sex.

“Do it inside,” she murmured into my ear. “I’ve stopped taking my birth control.”

“Really?” I breathed.

“I want your cum,” she whispered, then trailed kisses down my neck. “Just do it.”

I fucked her as hard as I could, driven on by the thought of what I was about to do — and felt her come undone beneath me, her body shaking as her orgasm washed over her, her moans spilling out into the air. I wasn’t far behind, the feeling of her climax pushing me over the edge. With a groan, I followed, my release hitting me like a wave, spilling into her, filling her pussy.

We stayed like that for a moment, our bodies still tangled, our breaths ragged as we came down from the high, the room quiet except for the sound of our heavy breathing. I rolled onto my back, pulling her close, her head resting on my chest, her fingers tracing lazy patterns across my skin.

“That was...” she whispered, her voice soft, her body still trembling slightly.

“Amazing,” I finished for her, pressing a kiss to the top of her head.

But as the afterglow began to fade, the thoughts I’d been trying to push away crept back in. The image of another man with her, touching her, being where I had just been. Had he come inside her? Into the condoms they used? Or had he pulled out and shot his load on her? It gnawed at me, even though I tried to shake it off.

I held her close, listening to her breathing slow as she drifted off to sleep. But as much as I wanted to let it go, my mind kept circling back to that night, to the man she called Shaun.

Even in the quiet of the room, with Emmie wrapped in my arms, I knew I couldn’t let it rest.

Chapter Three

The next morning, as sunlight filtered through the half-drawn curtains, I found myself staring at my reflection in the bathroom mirror, toothbrush hanging from my mouth, mind swirling with last night's revelations. The condom wrappers, Emmie's reluctant confession... it all swirled around in my head, despite how much I wanted to leave it behind. The sound of the kettle whistling snapped me out of my thoughts, reminding me that we still had a whole day ahead of us.

I walked into the kitchen, where Emmie was busy pouring herself a cup of tea. She looked beautiful, as always—her blonde waves falling casually over her shoulders, dressed in her fitted work trousers and blouse, already ready to face the day. But there was an edge of tension between us, words unspoken.

"Morning," she said, flashing me a smile that didn't quite reach her eyes. She sensed it too, that lingering weight from our conversation. "You want some eggs?"

"Yeah," I muttered, sitting down at the table and reaching for the newspaper I wasn't really going to read.

As Emmie moved about the kitchen, the sound of her soft humming did little to soothe the knot in my chest. I stirred my coffee absently, the events of last night replaying in my mind. Even though I told myself it shouldn't matter, I couldn't shake the feeling that it did.

When she set a plate of scrambled eggs down in front of me, I forced a smile, thanking her. She sat across from me with her tea, watching me

closely, her brows knitted in mild concern.

“You’re mad at me, aren’t you?” she said softly, not even touching her drink. It wasn’t really a question. She already knew.

I glanced up at her, startled by the directness, but I didn’t say anything at first. She sighed, running a hand through her hair before leaning back in her chair.

“Ryan, I can tell,” she continued. “It’s about what I told you last night, isn’t it? About what happened when we were apart.”

I pushed the eggs around my plate, then met her gaze. “I guess... yeah. It’s not that I don’t get it. We weren’t together, I know that. I just... I can’t help how I feel.”

Emmie’s eyes softened, but there was a flicker of frustration in them too. “You’re the one who left,” she said, her tone firm but not harsh. “You walked out, Ryan. I begged you to come back those first few weeks. Do you remember? I called, I texted... I even showed up at Luke’s house, and you wouldn’t see me.”

“I needed time to think,” I said, the words coming out slower than I intended. “You know why I left, Emmie. I thought our marriage wasn’t going anywhere. I needed space.”

“A year, though?” she countered, her voice tinged with hurt. “You left me alone for a year.”

I dropped my fork and rubbed my temples, trying to gather my thoughts. “I know, I know... I just—“ I took a breath. “In the end, I was the one who asked you to try again. And you... you were the one who wasn’t sure. You were reluctant. You didn’t want to at first.”

Emmie stared at me for a moment, like she was carefully choosing her next words. “Because we’d been apart for a long time, Ryan. A lot happened. People change. I wanted to make sure it was the right thing for both of us, not just a way to fill the gap.”

“But you were seeing someone,” I muttered, the words slipping out before I could stop them.

Her expression darkened slightly, but she didn’t break eye contact. “I wasn’t seeing someone. I slept with someone, yes. A mistake. But it wasn’t some relationship, and it wasn’t why I hesitated.”

I leaned forward, the tightness in my chest spreading. “Then what was it? Why did you hesitate when I asked you to come back?”

Emmie let out a breath, shaking her head slowly. “I hesitated because I didn’t want us to rush back into something that might break all over again. We both needed to be sure. And we were. Up until now, we’ve been happy, haven’t we? Things have been good, Ryan.”

I knew she was right. We had been happy, really happy, since getting back together. But now, it was like that happiness had a crack running through it, one I couldn’t ignore. I glanced down at my plate, my appetite long gone.

“Yeah,” I said quietly. “But this is still hard for me.”

I pushed the eggs around my plate again, barely noticing when Emmie set her tea down with a soft clink. The knot in my chest tightened, my mind swirling with all the things I hadn’t asked last night. I couldn’t help it. It was like an itch I couldn’t scratch, one that got worse the more I tried to ignore it. I needed to know.

“So... was he good?” I asked, the words slipping out before I could stop myself.

Emmie’s head jerked up, her eyes wide with disbelief. “What?” she said, her tone sharp. “Are you serious right now?”

I swallowed hard, feeling the weight of the question hanging between us. I could already see I’d pushed it too far, but the words just kept coming, tumbling out like I had no control. “I mean... was he better than me?”

Emmie stared at me, her lips parting as if to say something, but nothing came out. For a moment, it was like she couldn’t believe what she was hearing. She blinked, then shook her head slowly. “Ryan, you can’t be serious. That’s... that’s irrelevant.”

I leaned forward, feeling the jealousy eating at me, twisting everything into knots. “It’s not irrelevant. You slept with him twice, Emmie. Two condoms. It wasn’t just a quick one-off thing.”

Her eyes flashed with something I hadn’t seen in a while—frustration, maybe even a touch of anger. She looked away, her fingers gripping the edge of her teacup tightly. “I told you,” she said, her voice lower now, more measured. “I don’t remember much. I was drunk. It was a stupid, meaningless one-night-stand.”

“If you say so,” I muttered, the words slipping out before I could stop them, coated in sarcasm that I immediately regretted.

Emmie’s eyes snapped back to mine, narrowing as she stared at me, her jaw tightening. “What is that supposed to mean?”

I sighed, leaning back in my chair and rubbing my face with my hands. I knew I was crossing a line, but I couldn't help it. The thought of someone else touching her, being with her... it ate at me like poison. "I just mean... it's hard to believe it was *nothing*... You slept with someone else, it's hard to believe you can't remember it."

Emmie shook her head, her eyes filled with disbelief. "Ryan, what I can't believe is the fact that you're doing this. You have no right to ask me these things. What happened during our time apart is my business. You walked away, remember? I wasn't cheating. I didn't lie. We were over. And what I did with someone else is none of your concern."

I opened my mouth to apologise, knowing I'd gone too far, but the words stuck in my throat. "I didn't mean—"

"No," Emmie cut me off, her voice sharp now. "You don't get to ask me these questions. I told you last night because you found the condoms, but that should've been it. I don't owe you an explanation about what happened. It was a mistake. It meant nothing. That's all you need to know. That should be enough for you."

I tried to meet her eyes, but the hurt and frustration I saw there made me flinch. She was right. I'd pushed her into a corner, brought up things that were better left buried. I opened my mouth again to apologise, but before I could, Emmie stood up abruptly, pushing her chair back with a sharp scrape.

"I'm done talking about this," she said, her voice tight. "I regret it. I wish it never happened. But it did, and I can't change that. You need to get over it, Ryan. You're the one who left me. And now that we're back together, you need to let this go, or we're never going to move forward."

"I'm sorry," I murmured, finally managing to get the words out. "I shouldn't have—"

"I'll see you after work," Emmie cut in, grabbing her bag and heading for the door before I could say anything else. She was halfway out when she paused, her hand on the doorframe. Without turning around, she added, "And don't bring this up again. I'm serious. I'll talk about it if and when I'm ready."

She didn't wait for me to respond. The door slammed behind her, the sound echoing through the quiet kitchen, leaving me sitting there with the cold remnants of my breakfast and the heavy weight of my thoughts.

I rubbed my hands over my face, trying to clear the fog of frustration and regret. I'd pushed too hard, too soon. But no matter how much I tried to convince myself to let it go, I couldn't shake the image of her with someone else, couldn't shake the nagging feeling that there was more to the story than she was telling me. And now, I'd messed things up again.

I knew I needed to apologise properly. But for now, I had to go to work, even if my mind wasn't there.

The day dragged on endlessly, my focus slipping in and out as the argument from this morning replayed in my head. I tried to throw myself into work, but every task felt half-finished, my thoughts always circling back to Emmie's frustrated words, the way she slammed the door. I knew I'd gone too far, asking things I had no right to ask. But it was done, and now I had to find a way to make it right.

Around midday, I caved and sent her a text.

I'm sorry about this morning. I know I was out of line. Can we talk about it tonight?

I stared at the screen, waiting, hoping for a reply that might ease the tension tightening in my chest. A few minutes later, her message pinged back.

Forget it, Ryan. Just drop it, and I will too. Let's not bring it up again.

I frowned at the phone, her words doing little to settle the unease I felt. Was she shutting me down because she was hiding something? Or was it really just regret like she said? Maybe it was both. I couldn't tell anymore, and that only made my head spin more as the day dragged on. She was right, though. We needed to move forward, not dwell on the past. I texted back a quick *Okay*, but it didn't stop the questions in my head.

The hours passed slowly, the weight of the morning lingering like a fog over my thoughts. I tried to distract myself with meetings, client emails, anything to keep my mind busy. But when it was finally time to go home, the knot in my stomach had only tightened. I wasn't looking forward to facing Emmie tonight—not with this tension hanging between us.

When I walked through the front door that evening, the house felt heavy with unspoken words. Emmie was in the kitchen, stirring a pot of something on the stove. Her back was to me, and she didn't turn around as I dropped my keys on the counter. For a moment, I considered going straight to the living room and giving her space. But before I could move, she spoke, her voice steady but quieter than usual.

"Ryan, you're right. We need to talk."

I froze in the doorway, unsure of what to expect. I wasn't sure if she was still angry or if she'd calmed down since this morning. I stepped forward cautiously, pulling out one of the chairs at the kitchen table and sitting down.

Emmie turned, wiping her hands on a tea towel. Her expression wasn't angry—it was thoughtful, like she was carefully considering what to say next. The tension in the room wasn't as thick as it had been this morning, but it was still there, lingering in the space between us.

"I've been thinking about last night and this morning," she said, leaning against the counter. "About everything that's happened."

I nodded slowly, waiting for her to continue.

She took a breath, folding her arms across her ample chest. "Last night, when I told Luke and Natasha about us starting a family... I didn't plan that. It just came out." She paused, her hazel eyes locking onto mine. "But I said it because I wanted to show you that I'm committed to this, to us. That I've let the past go."

I blinked, surprised by her words. "You're saying you told them because... you felt bad?"

She nodded, her expression softening. "Yeah. After you found those condoms, I felt like I needed to show you that I'm done with all of that. I'm committed to our future, Ryan. I don't want you to think I'm still stuck in that time apart or... or hung up on what happened." She looked down, her fingers fidgeting with the edge of the towel. "That's why I let you finish inside me last night."

Her words hit me like a punch to the gut. I hadn't even considered the significance of that moment until now. It wasn't just spontaneous; it was her way of reaffirming her commitment. A gesture to show that the past was behind her, that she was ready to move forward with me, with our life.

"I'm fertile right now," she continued, her voice quiet. "I knew that. That's why I let you cum in me. I didn't say anything because I wanted it to

feel... natural. Not planned. But I needed you to understand that I'm all in. That I'm not holding back on our marriage anymore."

I let her words sink in, the realisation of what she was saying hitting me in waves. She wasn't just trying to move past the condoms or Shaun or whatever had happened during our break—she was trying to prove that our future was what mattered. That last night, with me finishing inside her, was her way of leaving everything behind and moving forward, towards something we'd both wanted for so long.

"So, that's why you told Luke and Natasha," I said, piecing it together. "To show me. To prove you're serious about us starting a family."

Emmie nodded, stepping closer to me now, her expression softening even more. "Yes. I wanted to show you that I'm done with the past, Ryan. We've been so happy since getting back together, and I don't want that to change. I don't want to keep going over what happened when we were apart. I want us to focus on what we have now, on our future."

Her words settled something inside me. The nagging doubts, the jealousy—it didn't disappear completely, but it eased. I could see that Emmie was genuine. She wasn't hiding anything to hurt me; she was trying to show me that she was ready for the next step, just like I was.

I stood up, crossing the room to her. Gently, I took her hand in mine, squeezing it softly. "I understand now," I said, my voice quiet. "I'm sorry I pushed you earlier. I just... I couldn't stop thinking about it."

Emmie looked up at me, her hazel eyes warm. "I know. And I get it, Ryan. But we have to let it go. We're building something new here. Something better."

I pulled her into a hug, holding her close, feeling the tension melt away as I breathed in her familiar scent. "I love you," I whispered against her hair.

She squeezed me tighter. "I love you too. And we're going to be okay."

As I held her, I felt the weight on my chest lighten, the future feeling a little brighter, a little more certain. We still had things to work through, but at that moment, I believed her. We were moving forward, together.

What I didn't know at that moment, is how things were about to suddenly change...

Chapter Four

A few days had passed, and things between Emmie and me were more or less back to normal. We'd managed to shake off the tension from our argument about the condoms, even though it still lingered in the back of my mind. Emmie seemed to have moved past it, so I was trying to do the same, moving on together.

It was a Saturday morning, and we were having breakfast together, warm sunlight streaming through the kitchen windows as Emmie chatted away about how her work week had gone – and how she needed a nice relaxing weekend to get over it. She was leaning against the counter, sipping her coffee, looking casual but gorgeous in her tank top and shorts, her hair still slightly messy from sleep.

“You know,” she said, giving me a sideways glance as she set her mug down, “Your hair’s getting a bit long, don’t you think?”

I raised an eyebrow, self-consciously running a hand through my hair. “Is it?”

“Mm-hmm,” she nodded, walking over to stand behind me, her fingers combing through the back of my hair. “You could use a trim.”

I smirked, catching her reflection in the kitchen window. “What, I’m not ruggedly handsome enough for you anymore?”

She laughed, leaning down to press a soft kiss on my cheek. “You’re always handsome, but I like you looking sharp.”

I chuckled, shaking my head. “Alright, alright. I’ll get it trimmed.”

“Why don’t you pop into Jen’s salon this afternoon?” she suggested, turning back to grab her coffee. “She mentioned that she hasn’t been that busy lately. You could stop by there before you meet Luke for drinks.”

I paused, looking at her, a slight frown tugging at my brow. “Jen’s?” Jen was Emmie’s older sister, the two of them were close.

“Yeah, why not?” she replied with a casual shrug. “It’s been a while since you’ve seen her anyway. And it’ll be good to catch up. You know how she is—she won’t let you pay anything.”

“Sure, I guess,” I said, trying not to overthink it. Maybe Emmie was trying to be helpful, but something about her suggestion stuck with me. Was this her way of smoothing things over after our argument? Or was she telling the truth – that my hair looked a bit unruly and Jen was a way of saving some money?

Either way, it wasn’t a bad idea. She was right — I did need a haircut, and I’d feel more comfortable meeting Luke afterwards with a fresh trim. I grabbed my phone, texting Luke to confirm our plans later, to meet in our favourite bar — coincidentally the same place where Emmie and I had first met.

“I’ll go this afternoon,” I said. “Maybe swing by the salon first, and then meet Luke for a drink direct from there.”

Emmie smiled, leaning in to give me a quick peck on the lips. “Sounds perfect. You’ll look great. Tell Jen I said hi.”

By the time I arrived at Jen’s salon later that afternoon, the place was buzzing with the usual weekend rush. Women sat in chairs getting their hair done, a few men lounged in the waiting area, flipping through magazines or scrolling on their phones. The familiar scent of hair products filled the air as I pushed through the glass door, spotting Jen across the room.

She was busy with a client, chatting away as she worked, but her pretty face lit up in a wide smile when she saw me.

“Hey, stranger!” she called out, waving me over. “I’ll be with you in just a second.”

I settled into the waiting area, glancing around the salon before my eyes landed back on Jen. She was attractive, her dark blonde hair tied up in a messy bun, strands falling loosely around her face. Her sharp features and

piercing blue eyes made her look younger than she was — she was older than Emmie by four years — and she had that effortless confidence that came from running her own business. Even though she was friendly enough, Jen had always been a bit intimidating to me.

As I watched her finish up with the other client, I had a sudden flashback to the night last week when everything changed.

“Yeah, Shaun. I’m pretty sure that was his name,” I recalled Emmie saying. *“It was... one of those nights, you know? I was with Jen. I was upset and drunk and wasn’t thinking straight, and I didn’t even plan for it to happen. It just did.”*

Those words from the other night played back in my mind, like an echo I couldn’t shake.

I was with Jen.

She’d mentioned that Jen was with her that night—the night she’d gotten drunk and slept with Shaun.

A few minutes later, Emmie’s sister waved her client goodbye and beckoned me over to her chair. “Come on, let’s get you looking sharp.”

I sat down, feeling the familiar sensation of the salon cape being wrapped around my shoulders. Jen ran her hands through my hair, inspecting it with a critical eye.

“You’ve really let this go,” she teased, grabbing her scissors.

“Yeah, I guess I have,” I replied with a chuckle. “Emmie said the same thing. She’s the one who sent me here, actually.”

Jen smiled, combing through my hair. “I’m glad she did. It’s good to see you.” I haven’t seen you since when? Oliver’s birthday?”

“Probably,” I shrugged, eyeing her through the mirror as she assessed my untidy locks. As Jen worked through my hair, we fell into the usual light chat—work, her latest clients, and what she’d been up to lately. I figured now was as good a time as any to subtly steer the conversation.

“So, what’s new?” I asked, glancing at her in the mirror. “You got a new boyfriend yet?”

Jen chuckled softly, shaking her head. “Nah, not really. No one special, anyway. Been keeping myself to myself mostly these days.”

I raised an eyebrow, playing up my curiosity. “You? Really? Come on, you’re a good-looking girl. You should have guys lining up for a date with you.”

She laughed again, this time more genuinely. “I’m sure you’d think so, but nah. I’ve just not been feeling it lately, you know?”

I nodded, keeping my tone casual. “Maybe Emmie should take you out one night. Be your wingman or something. You two used to go out and tear it up back in the day, didn’t you?”

Jen smiled, but there was a slight shift in her expression, something fleeting. “Yeah, we had some good nights out but then you came along and ruined it by making my little sister all respectable.”

I saw my opportunity. “She hasn’t *always* been respectable,” I said, trying to keep my voice light. “Actually, she mentioned that you two went out one night during our break—one night in particular where she got a bit... let’s just say *not respectable*.”

Jen’s fingers slowed for a moment as she cut, but her face didn’t give much away. “Oh, yeah? She told you about that?”

“Only recently,” I said with a shrug. “She opened up, and mentioned meeting some guy. Shaun, I think his name was?”

Jen’s eyes flicked toward the mirror, her reflection calm but her movements a little more deliberate. “Ah, *that* night. Yeah, she was pretty drunk. We both were. I wouldn’t worry about it or spend too much time pondering over that night.”

I pretended to laugh, trying to keep things easy. “Yeah, she said that too. She said she barely even remembers anything. Although, she’s always been good at forgetting stuff when she wants to.”

Jen’s laugh was softer this time. “Well, that’s a good skill to have. You should take a leaf out of her book and forget it too.”

I kept my tone light, but my gaze met hers in the mirror, watching for any sign of hesitation. “Yeah, I know... still, it’s been a bit of a shock. I didn’t know until she let slip the other day. I didn’t sleep with anyone during our break, so it feels kind of bad, you know?”

Jen’s hands stilled for a moment again, before she let out a sigh. “Ryan, I get it. But that night... it didn’t mean anything. Emmie was single at the time — we both were — but she was hurting, maybe she was missing you, I don’t know. It was just a stupid mistake.”

Her words were almost a mirror of what Emmie had said, and while they were comforting on the surface, there was still something about the whole situation that didn’t sit right with me. Maybe I was overthinking it. Or maybe there was more to the story.

But for now, I nodded, forcing a smile. “Yeah, you’re probably right. So, what happened? What’s the rest of the story? Did you get lucky that night too?”

Jen laughed lightly at my question, though there was something just a little off in her tone. “Well, I did end up with someone that night too... but honestly, it was nothing to write home about,” she said with a half-shrug. “One of those nights where the alcohol did most of the work, you know?”

I raised an eyebrow, genuinely caught off guard by her candour. I’d known Jen for years, and while she’d always been a serial dater, she’d never come across as particularly promiscuous. The open confession left me a bit unsettled like I’d just glimpsed a side of her I wasn’t supposed to see.

“Oh, yeah? So it was a good night for both of you then?”

Jen snorted. “Oh, definitely not. Let’s just say it wasn’t one of my proudest moments. I didn’t even get his name... He was maybe even more forgettable than Emmie’s guy.”

I chuckled, but something about the way she said it didn’t seem genuine. “Is that what Emmie said to you afterwards? That Shaun was unmemorable?”

Jen’s eyes flicked to the mirror, watching my reflection carefully. “Yeah. I mean...” she said, making a small gesture with her fingers, holding them a couple of inches apart, a grin tugging at the corners of her lips. “She told me he wasn’t exactly... well, you know... very big.” She laughed again, but it felt a bit forced. “That’s probably why she didn’t mention it to you. I bet she was embarrassed.”

I forced a laugh, trying to hide the unease creeping up my spine. “Really? I guess that’s a reason she was so vague about the whole thing.”

Jen gave me a knowing smile as she finished up, brushing some loose hairs off my neck. “You two are back together now, and that’s what matters. Forget what happened during your time apart.”

Her words lingered in the air, and I found myself nodding along. “Yeah, you’re right. I should just let it go.” But even as I said the words, something still bothered me slightly. Had Emmie really discussed Shaun’s penis size with her sister? That just didn’t seem right.

Jen gave my hair one final check, then patted my shoulder. “There you go, all sorted. You’re ready to wow Emmie tonight.” She smiled, but her eyes were still watching me, like she was gauging my reaction.

I stood up, grabbed my jacket and fished for my wallet. “Thanks, Jen. It looks great. I’m going out with Lee now for a few drinks.”

“Cool,” she said brightly, her earlier tension seemingly gone. “I don’t want your money, Ryan. You’re family. Now go out and have fun. And hey, don’t overthink things, alright? Sometimes, the past just needs to stay in the past.”

I nodded, tossing her a wave as I headed out of the salon. But as soon as the door swung shut behind me, I couldn’t shake the nagging feeling that something wasn’t adding up. Jen had been too smooth, too quick to offer reassurances. Emmie’s story and Jen’s lined up almost too well. But maybe it was just my paranoia talking. Maybe I was looking for something that wasn’t there.

Just as I started to walk towards my car, my hand automatically went to my phone to text Emmie that I’d be home soon, which made me pause. It wasn’t there. It must have slipped out of my pocket while I was having my hair cut. I doubled back to the salon, pushed the door open quietly and stepped inside, just as Jen’s voice drifted over from the back room.

“Yeah, he bought it,” she was saying, her voice low and hushed. “Completely. Hook, line and sinker. You owe me one for this, Em.”

I froze, my heart pounding in my chest. The door to the back room was ajar, and I could see Jen pacing as she talked on the phone, her tone conspiratorial.

“Don’t worry,” she continued. “I’m sure he’ll drop it now. His hair looks better too, by the way.”

As she giggled, my throat went dry. Should I question her? No. She wouldn’t tell me anything. Knowing Jen, she’d try to make me think I’d misheard or misunderstood. But I hadn’t.

I found my phone, nestled in the hairdresser’s chair, turned and slipped back out of the salon before she could see me, my head spinning.

When I made it back to the car, my heart still hammering in my chest, I stared at my phone for a moment, debating whether to call Emmie right then and there. But something stopped me. I needed time to process this. Maybe Luke would have some ideas on how best to deal with it, but just as I pulled away from the salon, a text came through to my phone.

It was from Luke: *Sorry, bro. Something’s come up. Can we take a raincheck?*

I texted back, telling him it was fine and not to worry. It was probably for the best, I wasn't in the right mental state for drinking.

I started the car again and drove straight home, my mind racing. When I arrived back earlier than expected, I stepped quietly through the door, still lost in thought, so much so that I didn't even realise that Emmie wasn't around. The door was unlocked, so she must be home. Perhaps she was upstairs,

I made my way through the hallway, the soft creak of the floorboards the only sound as I ascended the stairs. I was still reeling from what I'd overheard at the salon. Jen's voice replayed in my head. *You owe me one for this, Em...* It was clear they were hiding something. Something bigger than just one drunken night.

As I reached the top of the stairs, I noticed the bedroom door was slightly ajar, and a soft, muffled sound came from inside. My pulse quickened, and I stepped closer, careful not to make a sound. As I got near, I realised what the sound was—soft moans, barely audible but unmistakable.

I peered through the narrow crack in the door, my breath catching in my throat.

There, on the bed, was Emmie, lying back against the pillows, naked from the waist down, her legs slightly parted. Her hand gripped a large black vibrator tightly, pressing it against her clit, her eyes closed, lips parted in quiet gasps of pleasure. The low hum of the toy filled the room, mingling with the soft sounds of her moans. Her blonde hair fanned out over the pillow, and her body arched slightly as she moved, her hips lifting from the bed in a slow, rhythmic motion.

I should have looked away. I should have given her privacy, but I couldn't tear my eyes from the sight. She looked breathtaking, the soft light from the bedside lamp casting a golden glow over her smooth skin, the curves of her body moving in time with the pulsing vibration between her legs. The way her breasts rose and fell with each breath beneath the white T-shirt she wore. It was impossible not to watch. She looked so beautiful, so natural in her desire.

I should walk in, take the toy from her and give her a real cock, but I didn't. I'd never seen Emmie like this before. I mean, I assumed she masturbated sometimes — everyone does — but I'd never been witness to her private moments like this before and I was intrigued.

Then Emmie shifted slightly, her moans growing louder, pushing her T-shirt up to reveal that she wasn't wearing a bra. Her free hand caressed one of her full breasts, squeezing softly as her body responded to the growing pleasure. Her back arched higher, her movements more frantic now, more desperate, her hips grinding against the vibrator as she neared the edge.

She slid the toy downwards, pushing it between her soft folds, thrusting the long, black shaft deep inside her and keeping it there for a moment before plunging it in and out several times. The vibrator was slick with her juices as she pulled it out, returning it to her clit, pressing it urgently against the swollen bud.

I watched, entranced, my breath shallow as she reached her climax. Her moan turned into a high, breathless cry, her whole body tensing before shuddering with release. She collapsed back against the pillows, panting softly, the toy slipping from her hand and falling onto the bed beside her.

I stayed where I was, frozen at the sight of her cumming like that. She hadn't noticed me, lost in her fantasies. Finally, I slipped away before she noticed me, wandering back downstairs with a new question suddenly bothering me. Was she imagining me as she came undone on the bed—or was she thinking of the night she spent in another man's arms?

Chapter Five

The early afternoon sun shone warmly as Emmie and I walked up our garden path, our arms weighed down by shopping bags from the corner shop. The day felt deceptively normal. We'd shared the usual mundane conversations in the car—what we were having for dinner, Emmie mentioning how much work she had to do tomorrow—but beneath it, my thoughts kept drifting, circling around everything that had been bubbling beneath the surface lately.

As we neared our front door, our neighbours emerged from their own house, heading out somewhere. Laura and Mark had moved in about two years ago, a nice young couple—both barely in their twenties, young enough that I often felt a bit protective of them in a strange, older brother sort of way.

Laura caught sight of us and immediately waved, her smile lighting up her whole face. She was strikingly beautiful, in that fresh-faced, unselfconscious way that made you notice her twice. Her rich red hair cascaded down her back, and her brown eyes had a playful glint, one that often lingered a moment too long when she looked at me.

“Hey, Ryan! Hey, Emmie!” Laura called out, jogging over to the fence separating our front gardens, her busty chest bouncing in her tight sweater.

“Afternoon, Laura,” I said, forcing a smile that felt natural, despite my swirling thoughts.

Emmie gave her a small wave, her attention already drifting. I glanced at Laura again, catching the way her eyes traced over me, her smile a bit too

friendly. There had been a couple of times during our break, when she'd flirted—more than flirted—with me, inviting me around while telling me that Mark was out and wouldn't be back for a while. With Emmie gone, it would have been so easy to cross that line, to take her up on her unspoken offer of something more than friendship. But instead, I'd spent those months trying to figure out my feelings, wondering if Emmie and I could find our way back to each other, choosing to shut out whatever temptation Laura had presented.

"Doing a bit of shopping, eh?" Laura asked, her eyes flicking from me to Emmie.

"Yeah, just the weekly shop," Emmie replied, sounding absent-minded. "Hope you guys are doing well. I haven't seen you much lately."

Mark ambled over, waving with one hand while the other rested in his jeans pocket. He was a good kid, always polite, a perfect match for Laura's youthful exuberance. "All good here, thanks. We've been on vacation, probably why you haven't seen us."

"Hey," Laura added, sharing a look with her husband. "We're thinking of having a barbecue soon, maybe next weekend. You guys should come over."

Emmie nodded, though I could tell her mind was already somewhere else. "Yeah, that sounds nice," she said distractedly, before turning and heading toward our door.

Let me know the date and we'll see you then," I said, giving them both a wave before following Emmie inside.

The door shut behind us, and with it, the world outside seemed to disappear, replaced by the quiet awkwardness that I'd felt since the events of yesterday. We moved through the kitchen together, unpacking the groceries. Emmie was silent, her focus on the food as she placed everything in its designated spot.

I tried to join in, acting like everything was fine, but my thoughts wouldn't settle. The memory of Emmie and her vibrator last night kept replaying in my head, and the conversation I'd overheard from Jen at the salon bothered me, a persistent, uneasy reminder of what I didn't know. I forced myself to keep my tone light, to smile when Emmie caught my eye, but her gaze quickly shifted away, her own thoughts seemingly miles away.

We finished putting away the shopping, and I leaned against the counter, watching her as she fiddled with her phone, still seemingly lost in her own

world. I wanted to ask her if she was okay and about what I'd heard, to dig deeper into what she and Jen had been hiding from me, but every time I opened my mouth, the words caught in my throat.

What was I even supposed to say? *I eavesdropped on your sister and I think you're lying to me?* That wouldn't go over well. I could already imagine the storm of an argument, how petty it was for me to listen to her sister talking in private, and how out of line I was to ask questions about things she did while we were apart. No, part of me knew it was better to just let it lie, but another part couldn't stop imagining her with another man.

My phone buzzed in my pocket, and I pulled it out, glancing at the screen to see a message from Luke.

Sorry for yesterday, mate. Can I make it up to you? Pub this afternoon? First round's on me.

I sighed, grateful for the distraction. Maybe a drink with Luke was exactly what I needed—to clear my head, or at least, to push all this uncertainty aside for a while.

I looked over at Emmie. “Luke just texted,” I said, trying to sound casual. “He’s apologising for bailing on me yesterday. Wants to meet at the Red Lion this afternoon.”

Emmie nodded without looking up. “That’s fine. Have a good time.”

Her disinterest stung a bit, though I tried not to let it show. Usually, she’d at least ask me to pick up something on the way back or ask who else would be there, but today... she seemed barely aware of me. “Are you alright?” I asked, stepping a bit closer.

She finally looked up, offering me a small, distracted smile. “Yeah, I’m fine. Just work stuff on my mind and some stuff with Jen. You go, though. You could use a bit of time out.”

“Stuff with Jen?” I asked, my interest piqued. “You know, at the salon yesterday, she mentioned...”

“Sorry,” Emmie cut me off as soon as I mentioned her sister. “Ryan, I really do have something to sort out. Can we talk later?” It felt like a dismissal, but maybe she was right to not want to talk about it. Maybe space was what we both needed. I nodded, slipping my phone back into my pocket.

“Alright. I’ll be back in a few hours.”

I kissed her forehead—more out of habit than any real gesture of affection—and she barely responded, her attention already shifting back to

her phone. I grabbed my jacket from the hallway, feeling an odd weight settle in my chest as I stepped outside, closing the door quietly behind me.

The Red Lion hadn't changed in the years since I'd first met Emmie here—back when I was a nervous young man, trying to play it cool while this beautiful blonde girl sat across from me, her laughter lighting up the entire room. I smiled at the memory as I walked inside, the familiar scent of old wood and spilled ale greeting me like an old friend. Luke was already at the bar, waving me over with a grin.

"I feel like an asshole for cancelling on you yesterday," he said, handing me a pint. "Family stuff came up. Also, Natasha's ex was giving her some grief, so I stayed in to help her through it."

I raised an eyebrow, taking a sip of my pint. "Her ex, huh?"

Luke nodded, leaning on the bar. "Yeah, he doesn't bother her often, but every now and then, he pops up with something petty. She handles it well, though."

"Sounds like a pain in the ass," I said, as he passed me a glass of nice, cold, amber-coloured beer.

Luke sighed, shrugging. "Yeah, but it's alright. She's a tough one." He grinned, raising his glass. "Anyway, first round's on me. Here's to making up for yesterday."

I chuckled, clinking my beer against his. "You're forgiven. So, apart from the ex, how's everything else with you and Natasha? You seem pretty into her."

Luke's face lit up at her name. "She's great, mate. It's been a long while since I've felt like this about someone. She's a lot of fun, you know?"

"That's good to hear," I said, genuinely pleased for him. "You deserve it."

He took a sip of his drink and then looked at me more closely. "What about you? How are things with Emmie?" I hesitated, glancing down at my pint. "They're good. Mostly."

"Mostly?" Luke frowned, his curiosity piqued.

I shrugged, trying to play it off. "Something came up. Some stuff from when we were apart, you know? Things I didn't know about."

He arched an eyebrow. "Doesn't sound good. But you guys are strong. You'll get through it, right?"

I took another sip of my drink, grateful for his understanding. "I hope so."

“If you want to talk about it—whatever this stuff is—you know you can, okay?”

I nodded, appreciating the sentiment but I wasn’t ready to tell my best friend that my wife had fucked someone else. We lapsed into silence for a moment, then I looked up at him, the question slipping out before I could stop myself. “So, Natasha is fun, huh? Good in bed, you mean?”

Luke’s eyes widened slightly, and I immediately regretted saying it. “I mean—” I laughed, trying to cover my awkwardness. “I don’t know why I blurted that out. Ignore me.”

My best friend snorted, shaking his head. “Ah, don’t worry. You’ve been spending too much time thinking about whatever this stuff is between you and Emmie.” He laughed, but there was a flicker of curiosity in his eyes, a hint that maybe he wasn’t just brushing it off.

“Yeah, probably,” I muttered, taking another drink.

Luke took a long swig of his pint, his eyes sparkling with mischief. I thought we’d moved on from my inappropriate question, but then he leaned in closer, his voice lowering as if he was about to share some grand secret.

“Alright, since you asked so nicely,” he said, flashing me a cheeky grin. “I’ll tell you something. Natasha is... adventurous, shall we say? And pretty wild when she wants to be.”

I smirked, taking a sip of my drink. “Oh yeah?”

Luke nodded, clearly enjoying himself now that he had my attention. “You have no idea. She’s got this side to her... it’s like she’s all innocent and sweet most of the time, but when we’re alone... sometimes it’s like she flips a switch. She likes trying new things, and I’m not just talking about in bed, but... yeah, in bed too.”

I raised an eyebrow, playing along. “Like what?”

“Oh, you’re curious now, are you?” Luke laughed, giving me a nudge. “Let’s just say she’s got a bit of a kink for being watched. I’m sure she’s an exhibitionist. Last weekend, we were in a hotel in Liverpool. I told you we were going away for the weekend, if you recall? Anyway, she wanted the curtains open while we... you know.” He paused, a wicked grin spreading across his face. “I mean, it’s not like we were on the ground floor or anything, but still, it was broad daylight and anyone looking across from the buildings opposite would have seen everything.”

“Everything?” I felt my cheeks heat up slightly.

“We were both naked,” he shrugged, “We went at like rabbits, all afternoon. I have to admit, it was exciting. She knows exactly how to get my blood pumping, and don’t even get me started on her body...” He shook his head, almost in awe. “She’s slim but with curves in all the right places. She looks after herself, got a nice pair, a tight ass and... well, let’s just say she knows what she’s doing in bed.”

I chuckled, shaking my head. Luke always had a way of oversharing, but I couldn’t help but feel a little envious—not necessarily because of Natasha herself, but more for the way Luke spoke about her like he was utterly captivated.

“Here you go,” Luke said, looking over his shoulder while sliding his phone from his pocket. I watched as she turned the screen to face me, then went into his messages, bringing up the most recent one—from Natasha. Then he clicked to open it and I was presented with a photo of her, her green T-shirt raised in her hands, her bare breasts exposed. They were round and firm with small, dark-pink nipples.

Have fun with Ryan, the message beneath it read. Don’t miss me too much. I’ll see you tomorrow night.

Luke leaned back, giving me a cheeky grin. “What do you think?”

I blinked, unable to believe that he’d just shown me his girlfriend’s breasts.

“She’s gorgeous,” I managed to say, taking a long pull from my glass to cover my surprise. “You’re a lucky guy.”

“I know... so, enough about me. What about you and Emmie? Is the sex as good now as it was before? You two have been through a lot. Must’ve added a bit of spice, yeah?”

I shifted in my seat, glancing down at my pint. “I mean, it’s... yeah, it’s good,” I said, trying to keep my tone casual. But Luke wasn’t letting it go—I could see the curiosity written all over his face.

“Come on, mate,” he teased, nudging me again. “I just showed you Nat’s boobs. You must have something fun to share with your oldest friend.”

I blinked, caught out by the sudden turn in conversation. Luke and I had often talked about women in the past, but never quite as candidly as this.

I sighed, shaking my head but unable to suppress a smile. “I don’t have any nudes on Emmie on my phone. Sorry.”

“I’m not talking about photos,” Luke sighed. “I’m just curious how things are in the bedroom since you got back together. I reckon Emmie knows a

trick or two. You wouldn't have gone back to her if she didn't. I mean... You could have screwed that girl you live next door to. And then there's that gorgeous little thing you work with—“

“Sophie?” I replied. “No. She's my work colleague. I wouldn't go there.”

“Right,” Luke nodded, his grin widened. “Sure you wouldn't. Because Emmie keeps you totally satisfied, right?”

He wasn't going to let this drop until I gave him something. “I guess... Alright, alright. About Emmie... yesterday I got back early, right? After you cancelled, I headed home early after getting my hair cut. And there she was, upstairs, in our bedroom. Masturbating. Using a vibrator. She wasn't expecting me back so soon.”

“No way,” Luke said, leaning in, his grin widening. “And you joined in?”

I hesitated, then shook my head. “No, I watched. For a bit. I mean, it was... hot. We've used sex toys together, but I've never seen her use one herself. So I just watched until she finished.”

“Wow,” my friend chuckled. “You should have filmed it for your best friend here.”

“What?”

“I'm joking.” Luke's expression softened, the teasing glint fading from his eyes. “Emmie sounds like a sexual woman. But you should have joined in—got on with that baby-making project you were telling us about.”

“I know I should have,” I replied, smiling as if nothing was troubling me but then the feeling got the better of me. “I'm just curious what she was thinking about as she did it.”

“Who knows?” Luke shrugged. “Maybe she was imagining a foursome with you, me and Natasha.”

“Huh?” I stared at him before realising he was joking.

“Ryan, you're overthinking it. Relax. Whatever it is that you've got going on—and you obviously have something bothering you—you two are solid. She wouldn't be doing all this—talking about starting a family, moving forward—if she wasn't all in on you.”

I nodded, trying to take his words to heart. I wanted to tell him about the two condom wrappers but I just couldn't. Not yet. Not until I'd worked it out. “Yeah, maybe. I just... I don't know. Sometimes I feel like there's more she's not telling me. Something from when we were apart.”

“Look, mate,” Luke said, clapping me on the shoulder. “If there's one thing I've learned, it's that the past can't be changed. You've got to focus on

what you've got now, and from where I'm sitting, you've got a pretty damn good thing going. Don't let your head ruin it for you."

I smiled, raising my glass. "Thanks, mate. I needed that."

"Anytime," Luke said, clinking his glass against mine. "Now, enough of this heavy shit. Let's get drunk and talk about something fun for a change."

I laughed, the tension easing just a little as we turned the conversation to lighter things, but the thoughts of Emmie and everything that still felt unsaid lingered at the back of my mind, refusing to let go.

Chapter Six

The sun was long past the horizon and the rapidly darkening sky was a dull, dark grey as I walked towards home. My mind was still pleasantly fuzzy from the drinks at the pub with Luke, my thoughts were mostly focused on Emmie, but as I approached our house, I heard the low rumble of an engine. I looked up just as a car pulled up along the curb outside the house next door.

It was Laura, alone, returning from wherever she'd been. She parked her car, her red hair catching the glow of the streetlights as she glanced over and saw me walking down the street. Her eyes lit up, a smile quickly spreading across her lips. She stepped out of the car, her fitted jeans and snug jumper highlighting her curvy body. The kind of figure that drew attention effortlessly.

"Hey, Ryan!" she called, her voice filled with warmth and enthusiasm. She gave a little wave before shutting the car door behind her, slinging her handbag over her shoulder as she walked towards her garden gate.

"Hey, Laura," I responded, forcing a smile as I slowed my pace slightly. The truth was, I never quite knew how to handle Laura. She was always so friendly, always so... forward. And I couldn't deny that she was gorgeous—anyone with eyes could see that. But the way she looked at me, her lingering, flirtatious gaze, always left me feeling uneasy.

Laura caught up with me at the fence that separated our gardens, leaning over it slightly, her cleavage visible through the tight fit of her jumper. "Been out with the lads, have you?"

I nodded, a chuckle escaping me. “Yeah, just a couple of pints with my best friend. Nothing too exciting.”

“Well, I’m sure you deserved it,” she said, her voice dipping slightly, her eyes locking onto mine. “Though I can’t help but think Emmie must get a little lonely with you out all afternoon. I know what it’s like. I get lonely too when Mark goes away.” She gave me a playful grin, her gaze lingering as if waiting for me to respond.

I shrugged, trying to keep my tone light. “I think she manages just fine,” I said, forcing another smile. “She’s probably enjoying the peace and quiet, to be honest.”

Laura laughed, her eyes narrowing slightly in that flirtatious way she had. “Well, if you ever need to get out — give her more of that *peace and quiet* — you know where to find me. You’re always welcome to call around. Mark’s away a lot these days, so I’m always looking for company.” She winked, the suggestion hanging in the air between us.

I felt my face heat up, a mix of awkwardness and unease churning in my stomach. I cleared my throat, shifting my weight awkwardly. “I’ll... keep that in mind,” I said, not quite sure what else to say. The truth was, during our break, there were moments when I’d seriously considered taking Laura up on one of these less-than-subtle offers. But now, with Emmie and me rebuilding things, it felt wrong—even if nothing had happened.

Laura gave me one last lingering look before she turned, her hips swaying as she walked up her garden path. “See you around, Ryan,” she called over her shoulder, probably knowing that I was staring at her curvy ass.

“Yeah... see you,” I muttered, watching her disappear into her house before turning towards my own front door and stepping inside.

The house was quiet apart from the sound of the TV playing in the front room. I slipped off my shoes, the soft thud of them hitting the floor echoing slightly. As I stepped into the living room, I found Emmie sitting on the sofa, her phone in her hand, her attention focused on the screen. She glanced up when she heard me, her hazel eyes locking onto mine.

“You’re back,” she said, her voice casual, but there was a hint of something else beneath it—something I couldn’t quite place.

“Yeah, just got in,” I replied, trying to match her tone. I hesitated for a second, then added, “Have you been okay?”

“I saw you talking to Laura outside,” Emmie’s gaze flicked towards the window, her brow furrowing. “She needs to keep her hands off my husband.

I see the way she looks at you.”

I nodded, swallowing the lump in my throat. “Yeah, she... she said ‘hi.’ She’s just flirty, that’s all.” I tried to play it off, but the way Emmie kept watching me, her eyes narrowing slightly, made me feel like I was being scrutinised.

“Well, she shouldn’t be, You’re married,” Emmie said, her voice light but carrying an edge to it. She set her phone down, her gaze never leaving mine.

I forced a chuckle, shaking my head. “Yeah, I guess so. But it was nothing, Em. You don’t have to worry about her. I think she just enjoys teasing me.”

Emmie nodded slowly, her expression softening, but there was still something in her eyes—a flicker of doubt, or maybe curiosity. “Right. Well, as long as that’s all it is.” She smiled then, a smile that didn’t quite reach her eyes.

I crossed the room, leaning down to press a kiss to her lips, trying to dispel whatever tension had crept in. “Of course, that’s all it was.”

Emmie returned the brief kiss, then leaned back into the sofa, letting out a sigh as I sat next to her. “While you were out, I went to the gym. I thought I’d do something useful instead of just hanging around waiting for you to come back.”

My brow lifted slightly in surprise but I shouldn’t be surprised. She was still wearing her tracksuit top and leggings. “The gym? On a Sunday?” It wasn’t like Emmie going on the weekend; she normally preferred going after work during the week, fitting it around her schedule. Sundays were usually our quiet days together.

“Yeah,” she said, pushing herself up from the sofa and stretching. “I just... needed to get out of the house, do something active. Otherwise, I would’ve just sat here and wasted the whole afternoon.” She paused, her lips curling into a small smile. She dipped her head to smell her armpit. “Now I’m all sweaty, though. I think a shower’s in order.”

I watched her, a curious glint in my eye. Emmie had always been beautiful, but there was something different about her from this morning—something that seemed more relaxed, despite the slight tension between us over Laura. Maybe going to the gym had helped her clear her head.

She rose from the sofa, picking up an empty glass from the table and taking it through to the kitchen. I followed her, leaning against the

doorframe and crossing my arms. “So, how was it? The gym, I mean. I hope it was better than my afternoon of Luke oversharing his adventures with Natasha.”

“Oh, so that’s how you spent the afternoon, is it?” She paused, her smile widening. “Listening to Luke divulging his escapades with his latest girlfriend?”

“He definitely shared a lot more than I needed to know.” I chuckled, shaking my head. I wasn’t about to tell her that he’d shown me a photo of her tits. “Natasha likes to keep things... interesting, shall we say? But I told him we were doing just fine ourselves.” I met her gaze, watching as her expression shifted—softening, a flicker of something playful there.

“Did you now?” she murmured, stepping closer, her eyes searching mine.

I reached out, my fingers brushing her arm lightly. “We’re doing better than fine, aren’t we? We’re trying for a baby.”

For a moment, she held my gaze, then nodded, stepping back slightly. “Yes, we are,” she said softly. “And I think we’re ready to take things up a notch.” She gave me a look, one that sent a thrill through me, before she turned and headed towards the stairs. “But first, a shower.”

She turned and headed upstairs to take a shower, leaving me to freshen up in the kitchen. I washed my hands, splashed some water on my face, and took a deep breath, trying to shake off the slight fuzz from the beers Luke and I had enjoyed earlier. I needed to clear my head, to focus on what mattered most—Emmie and the time we had together.

A few minutes later, I heard Emmie’s voice call down from upstairs. “Ryan! Can you help me with something?” she called, her voice carrying a playful lilt.

Curiosity piqued, I made my way up the stairs and into the bathroom. Emmie was standing under the hot spray of the shower, completely naked, her blonde hair, darker because it was wet, clinging to her back, cascading in tangled waves down her shoulders. Her soft, pale skin glistened under the warm, steamy mist. Water flowed over the curves of her large breasts, dripping from the tips of her nipples. She turned slightly, her gaze catching mine, a mischievous smile curling her lips, her eyes hinting at something far more daring.

“Get in here,” she beckoned, her eyes locking onto mine. “Come on, get naked and join me.”

I needed no further invitation. I quickly stripped off my clothes, grinning like the Cheshire Cat as I stepped into the warm, misty shower beside her. The hot water hit my skin, and I could feel the tension beginning to melt away.

Emmie stepped closer, her hands sliding over my chest as she pressed her body against mine. She tilted her head up, her lips brushing against my ear. “So, tell me more about what Luke said. You know... about Natasha.” Her voice was teasing, but there was an edge to it, a genuine curiosity.

I swallowed, my pulse quickening as her fingers traced patterns over my wet skin. “Natasha likes putting on a bit of a show,” I said, my voice low. “Luke told me they kept the curtains open while they had sex at their hotel last weekend. He said she loved it—knowing people might be watching.”

Emmie’s eyes widened slightly, her lips curling into a smile as she slowly knelt in front of me, her hands sliding down my stomach. “An exhibitionist, huh?” she murmured, her voice taking on a husky tone. Her fingers wrapped around my stiffening cock, her lips brushing against it as she looked up. “And what about you? Did hearing all of that make you jealous of Luke? Would you like me to be naughtier, too?”

I shook my head, my breath catching as she took me into her mouth. “No,” I managed, my voice strained. “You’re more than enough for me, Em. Always have been.”

Her hazel eyes held mine for a moment before she closed them, taking me deeper, her mouth hot and insistent as she began to suck my length. I closed my eyes, my head tipping back against the tiled wall, my thoughts drifting. Despite what I’d said, images flashed through my mind—visions of Emmie being naughtier. But for some reason, they weren’t with me. I imagined her with another man, of her doing this to him. The thought made my heart pound, a mix of jealousy and arousal surging through me.

Was this what she was like with him? Did she shower with him? Did she suck his cock before he fucked her twice? Was she naughtier, more adventurous, in a way she thought I couldn’t handle?

Emmie’s moans echoed softly in the steam-filled shower, her hands gripping my thighs as she worked me, and I could feel my control slipping. She stood up then, her eyes blazing with desire as she pulled me close, her voice barely a whisper. “Let’s go to the bedroom and fuck.”

I didn’t need to be asked twice, but I couldn’t wait until we got to the bedroom. As she stood, I turned her gently, pressing her against the wet

tiles, my hands sliding down to her hips as I entered her shaved pussy from behind. The heat of the water, the slickness of her skin, the sound of her breathy moans—it all blended together, a heady rush that left me dizzy. She arched her back, her hands bracing against the wall, and I moved with her, each thrust harder than the last, her body pressing back into mine.

“Don’t cum yet,” she breathed. “Please, let’s go to the bedroom. I want to be naughty for you.”

I released her from where I had her, pressed against the wall of the shower and she took me by the hand and led me into the bedroom.

“We should close the—“ I began to say, meaning the wide open curtains.

“I can be naughty too,” Emmie giggled sexily, refusing to let go of me as I meant to walk towards them. “Just fuck me. I don’t care if anyone sees us.”

With that, she turned and bent over the bed, offering me her sexy, still-damp behind and again, I didn’t hesitate.

I grabbed her hips after guiding my cock back into her warm, wet pussy and fucked her hard and fast.

“Yes...” she gasped, her voice breaking. “Please... don’t stop.”

I couldn’t stop even if I wanted to. The tension built, the world narrowing to just the two of us as I let all of the tension ride out of me by fucking my gorgeous wife. Emmie’s cries grew louder, more desperate, and her tits made a soft slapping sound as they rocked against her with every hard thrust I gave her. I felt the pressure inside me reach its peak, my release hitting me with a force that left me breathless. I held her close as my seed pumped into her and then she came too, her body trembling against mine.

We stayed like that for a moment, our breathing heavy and then crashed onto the bed, finding each other immediately to embrace the afterglow of our spontaneous unison. Emmie smiled at me, her eyes still half-lidded with desire.

“That was fun,” she said softly, her body warm as it pressed against mine. “I love you.”

“I love you too,” I replied but just then, her phone rang from the other side of the room.

“Ignore it,” I suggested but she got up reluctantly and looked at the name on the screen. “It’s Jen,” she called over her shoulder, picking up the phone and answering it as she walked out of sight, her voice growing distant as she spoke.

I heard her voice disappear as she took the call into the bathroom, then stood up, reaching for a fresh pair of boxers, but as I glanced out of the window, I caught sight of movement in the garden next door. It was Laura, standing on her back patio, a cigarette in her hand, her eyes lifting to meet mine through the glass.

Her lips curled into a slow smile, her gaze lingering as she took a drag, the smoke curling around her face. My heart skipped a beat, a jolt of panic rushing through me as I realised I was still naked. I quickly reached for the curtains, pulling them shut, my breath catching in my throat.

Had she seen anything? From the angle, ten feet or so below us, I was sure she couldn't have seen anything of me or Jen below the waist. The window was open too. Had she heard us having sex? I wanted to open the curtains and look back but I daren't.

I pushed Laura from my mind. I had more important things to worry about than our sassy next-door neighbour. I needed to focus on Emmie. I should push the paranoid notion that she and Jen were hiding something from me, forget what she might or might not have done during our break. Forget about Lauren and Natasha and everything else that was occupying my mind lately.

However, something was about to stop that from ever happening.

Chapter Seven

It was Monday morning, and I was sitting at my desk at work, trying to keep my head in the present. The weekend had been a strange one, filled with moments I wanted to remember forever and others I wished I could forget. I took a sip of the lukewarm coffee on my desk, staring at the screen in front of me without really seeing it. My thoughts kept drifting back to last night—the way Emmie had pulled me into the shower, the feel of her body under the hot spray. I smiled slightly, focusing on that memory. The spontaneity of the sex, the fun we'd had. It was everything I wanted our relationship to be. I needed to move forward, to leave everything else behind—the condom wrappers, Jen's hushed conversation on the phone. I needed to let it go, for Emmie's sake, for both of us.

But it wasn't just that. The look from Laura last night lingered in my mind. Had she seen us? Heard us? And if she had, how awkward was it going to be the next time I bumped into her? I shook my head slightly, trying to brush the thought away. I couldn't afford to get caught up in that. Not now.

And then there was Natasha. Luke's girlfriend. The picture he showed me flashed in my mind, uninvited, and it made me wonder how weird things would be the next time I saw her too. Would I be able to look her in the eye without thinking about the picture of her bare breasts on Luke's phone? Without remembering the proud grin as he showed me? I sighed, closing my eyes for a moment. I needed to get a grip.

I was in the middle of trying to focus on an email when I heard a voice behind me.

“Morning, Ryan,” T.J. said, leaning casually against the edge of my desk. T.J. was a tall guy, broad-shouldered with a wiry but athletic build that suggested he worked out but didn’t take it too seriously. His dark skin had a natural glow, and his short-cropped hair always looked effortlessly styled. He had a laid-back way about him, his eyes always carrying a hint of mischief, which made him both approachable and a bit of a wildcard. He worked in client services like me — but was also our big-brain computer guy — and we’d always gotten on well. T.J. had this knack for making even the most stressful situations seem less dire.

I looked up, smiling casually like I hadn’t just been picturing my best friend’s girlfriend’s tits.

“Morning. What’s up?”

T.J. shrugged, glancing around before leaning in slightly. “Helen wants to see you in her office. She said it’ll only take a minute.”

I frowned. “Did she say what it’s about?”

“Nope.” He gave a lazy grin. “But Sophie’s in there too. Maybe it’s something good?”

Somehow, I doubted that. Sophie was a colleague but Helen was my boss. Meetings with her usually weren’t good. I pushed my chair back, standing up. “Alright, cheers for the heads-up.”

I made my way down the corridor to Helen’s office, my stomach twisting slightly. I never enjoyed my meetings with Helen. She’d always had a particular way of making me feel like I was one wrong move away from being shown the door. It wasn’t that she was outright rude, but there was a coldness to her that I couldn’t shake, a sense that she had no love for me, and she wasn’t particularly interested in hiding it.

I knocked on the door, pushing it open when I heard Helen’s voice call me in. She was sitting behind her desk, her expression neutral, her dark hair pulled back in its usual severe bun. She was in her forties, her sharp features framed by angular cheekbones, her lips painted in a muted red that contrasted with her otherwise minimal makeup. Her dark eyes, always observant, held a hint of impatience behind her rectangular glasses. She wore a fitted grey blazer over a crisp white blouse, the kind of outfit that demanded authority, and her posture was as rigid as ever, her back straight,

her shoulders squared. Sophie was standing near the window, her arms crossed over her chest, her head turning as I entered.

“Ryan,” Helen said, her tone brisk. “Take a seat.” She gestured towards the chair in front of her desk, and I sat, glancing over at Sophie, who gave me a small, almost apologetic smile.

“We’ve got a bit of a reshuffle happening with client management,” Helen began, her eyes flicking towards the folder on her desk. “Sophie’s taking over a new account—a big one—so she’ll be handing off some of her smaller clients. Specifically, the Mitchell Davison account.”

My stomach sank at the mention of Mitch’s name. I glanced at Sophie, who gave me another apologetic look.

“Mitch and I go back a long way,” I said slowly, trying to keep my tone neutral. “I’m not sure I’m the best person to handle his account.”

Helen raised an eyebrow, her gaze unwavering. “I’m aware of your history. But Sophie’s workload is shifting, and you’re the most familiar with the account. I need you to step up and handle it, Ryan.”

I glanced at Sophie again, who spoke up then. “I’m sorry, Ryan. I know you didn’t enjoy working with him last time, but this new client I’m taking on—it’s a big deal. I wouldn’t ask if it wasn’t important.”

I swallowed, nodding slowly. I knew there wasn’t much of a choice here. Helen had made up her mind, and I wasn’t in a position to argue. “Alright,” I said finally, trying to keep the reluctance out of my voice. “I’ll take Mitch back.”

“Good,” Helen said, her tone clipped. “I’ll let him know. And, Ryan? I expect you to give this your full attention. No excuses.”

“Of course,” I said, standing as she dismissed me with a nod. Sophie followed me out of the office, her expression softening as soon as we were out of Helen’s sight.

“I’m really sorry, Ryan,” she said, her voice quiet. “I know Mitch is... difficult.”

“Yeah, that’s one way to put it,” I said, glancing at her. Sophie was gorgeous in that unconventional way that always seemed to catch me off guard. She had dark, Mediterranean features, her skin a warm olive tone, her eyes lined with dark makeup that gave her that goth or emo vibe. Her hair was dyed a deep shade of burgundy, and I could see the glint of her nose ring in the fluorescent lights of the hallway. A couple of times in the

past, when she was wearing tight blouses, I'd also seen the hint of a nipple ring. I wondered where else she had pierced.

She smiled, her lips curving slightly. "If it's any consolation, I'll owe you one for this. Maybe I can take you out for a drink sometime, to make up for it."

I chuckled, shaking my head. "You don't owe me anything, Sophie. Besides, you know I'm married."

"I know," she said, her smile widening. "But a drink doesn't have to mean anything, right?"

I nodded, trying to ignore the way my pulse quickened slightly. Despite Sophie's unconventional appearance, she had something about her that drew me in. There had been a time, during my break from Emmie, when I'd seriously considered asking Sophie out. But I hadn't. Not because I wasn't interested, but because I hadn't felt like I was over Emmie—I wasn't ready to move on. And now, with Emmie and I back together, I couldn't afford to let myself think about what might have been.

We reached my desk, and I gave Sophie a small nod as she turned to head back to her own workspace. T.J. was sitting at his desk across from mine, his eyes flicking between Sophie's retreating form and me, a grin spreading across his face.

"Everything alright?" he asked, his voice filled with that casual curiosity he always had.

"Yeah," I said, dropping into my chair. "Helen wants me to take the Mitchell Davison account back."

T.J. let out a low whistle. "Ouch. That guy's a pain in the ass. Didn't you have him before?"

"Yep," I muttered, clicking open my emails. "And I wasn't exactly heartbroken when Sophie took him off my hands."

"I wouldn't mind putting something in Sophie's hands," T.J. chuckled, nodding in the direction Sophie had gone. "She's totally into you, you know."

I glanced at him, raising an eyebrow. "Sophie? Come on, T.J. She's just being friendly."

"Friendly, my ass," he said, grinning. "There's chemistry between you guys, I'm telling you. You're a married man, yeah, I get it. But you must see it?"

I shook my head, ignoring his teasing. “Drop it, T.J. I’m married. Happily married.”

T.J. held his hands up in mock surrender, his grin never fading. “Alright, alright. I’m just saying.”

He turned back to his own work, and I tried to do the same, bringing up the files on Mitch that Sophie had just emailed over. The familiar dread settled in my chest as I scanned through the documents. Mitch had always been a nightmare—demanding, impatient, and with an ego that could fill a stadium. I’d first had to deal with him at school. He was in the same year as me and a complete bully. Now, ten years later, he was still the same arrogant ass, so I knew exactly what kind of headaches I was in for.

I sighed, clicking through the files, trying to focus, when another email arrived in my inbox. My blood froze in my veins when I saw the subject line.

It read: *I know about Emmie.*

My stomach dropped, my pulse quickening as I opened the email, my heart pounding as I read the message.

I know everything. You should too.

Below the message was a photo of Emmie, dressed up, on a night out in her favourite little black dress, her cleavage glowing in the yellow glow of the street lights, wherever she was. Obviously, whoever she was out with that night had taken a picture of her.

I stared at the screen, my mouth suddenly dry. The email address was nondescript. A throwaway series of random numbers at Yahoo.com. My fingers felt numb as I typed a response, my hands trembling slightly.

Who is this?

I didn’t know if they’d reply or how long it would take but after only a minute, then another message came through.

You’ll find out soon enough. But first, take a look at this.

A video file was attached, and my mouse pointer hovered over it for a moment before I double-clicked on it, my heart hammering in my chest.

The video opened in a new window and started playing once I clicked on the play icon, and I felt my stomach twist painfully as the image filled the screen. It was Emmie. Naked. On her knees. Her hair was different, a little shorter like it had been when we first got back together and there was no sound to the video, but there was no mistaking it was her.

My wife was on her knees as a man's thick, hard cock, belonging to the cameraman entered the shot. To my shock, Emmie didn't hesitate, her lips wrapping around the bulbous head, her head bobbing as she took him deeper, her eyes half-closed in pleasure. The scene was dim but I could see everything, the ridges on his large penis, her bare breasts swaying slightly with her movements. She was kneeling on a bed but I couldn't tell if it was ours or someone else's, the rumpled sheets beneath her a stark contrast to the smoothness of her skin. Her expression was one of concentration, her lips glistening as they moved back and forth along the length of him, her tongue flicking out occasionally to tease the sensitive tip. The man's hand came into view, his fingers tangling in her wavy blonde hair as he guided her pace, his hips thrusting subtly in time with her movements.

I watched, unable to look away, my mind a tangled mess of emotions—disbelief, anger, arousal. The way she moved, the way she was so focused on pleasuring him—it was intimate in a way that made my stomach twist. She moaned, her eyes flickering up to meet the camera for a brief second, her gaze filled with something I couldn't quite place—something that made my chest tighten painfully. I could feel my face growing hot, and my heart pounding in my ears.

Emmie and I had never so much as made a home porno on our phones, let alone something like this. I hit the pause button, staring at the screen, at the image of my beloved wife with another man's cock in her mouth. It seemed surreal that I was seeing such a thing and I knew I should close the video and not watch any further but I couldn't help myself. I hit play again.

The man's grip on her hair tightened as he pushed her down further, her lips stretching around him, her eyes closing as she took him deeper. Emmie gagged for a second and my heart almost stopped, concern flooding through me, even though this was a recording and not real-time. She soon recovered, her cheeks hollowing as she sucked him, her movements becoming more urgent, her body shifting slightly as if she was trying to find a more comfortable position on her knees. Her hand wrapped around the base of his lengthy cock, stroking in time with her mouth, her other hand resting on his thigh for balance.

I swallowed hard, my throat dry, watching as she pulled back, her lips releasing him and she seemed to take a deep breath. She looked up at him, her eyes heavy-lidded, a small smile playing on her lips. She said something – I wished the video had sound but it didn't – and then she

looked up at him, nodding as if he replied to her, his hand still tangled in her hair. She nodded again at whatever he was saying, biting her lower lip, before leaning forward again, her tongue flicking out to trace a line along his length, her eyes never leaving his face.

I couldn't believe what I was watching. Again, I felt my conscience tell me to stop watching. That this would damage me, damage Emmie and I, but I couldn't stop. I let it play on.

Emmie was enjoying it—there was no denying that. The way she moved, the way she looked at him—it was like she was completely lost in the moment, completely focused on pleasing him. I felt my cheeks growing hotter, a mix of jealousy and arousal surging through me as I watched my wife pleasuring another man. I hated it. I hated that she had done this, that she had been with another man, and yet... I couldn't deny the heat that was building inside me, the way my body was reacting to the sight of her like this, my cock stiffening in my pants. I told myself that it was okay — that this had happened while we were apart, while we were both single. She was just responding to her needs. Drunk. Out of control. A mistake.

But it didn't look like a mistake. The man's hand tightened in her hair again, and he pulled her back, his cock slipping from her lips. She looked up at him, her expression changing as she appeared to listen to something he was saying, her lips swollen and glistening. She nodded once more, a smile tugging at her lips as she slowly turned, her body shifting as she got up on all fours. She looked back at him over her shoulder, her eyes filled with anticipation as she arched her back, her ass raised invitingly.

The camera angle shifted slightly, and I could see the man's hand come down to grip her hip, his other hand guiding himself to her soft, shaved entrance — his cock now wrapped in the clear latex of a condom. Emmie's eyes fluttered closed, her lips parting as he pushed against her, into her... and then the video ended abruptly.

I stared at the black screen. The image had disappeared but it was burned into my mind. Emmie—my Emmie—bending over, about to be fucked by another man. The way she sucked his cock, the way she looked up at him, the way she moved, ready to be fucked—it was all too much, too raw, too real.

Another email came through.

I hope you enjoyed the video. I'll be in touch soon.

I swallowed, my mouth dry, my thoughts a chaotic swirl of confusion and disbelief. My mind raced, trying to piece it together. Who was this? How did they have this video? When had it been taken? Was this the man she'd been with during our break? And why now? Why send this to me now?

I quickly typed an email back.

I hope you know this is wrong. You could get into trouble. Who are you and what do you want?

A reply came back quickly. Too quickly.

Message undeliverable, it read. This email address doesn't exist or has been blocked by our servers.

"Fuck," I cursed under my breath then I heard footsteps approaching, and I quickly minimised the email, hiding it just as Sophie appeared around the corner of my cubicle. She smiled, holding up a folder. "Hard copy of the Mitchell Davison files," she said, her eyes flicking to my face, her smile fading slightly. "Everything okay, Ryan? You look a bit pale."

I forced a smile, my heart still pounding, the video playing on a loop in my mind. "Yeah, I'm fine. Just... Mitch, you know?"

"Well, if you need anything, you know where I am." Sophie raised an eyebrow, not convinced that I was okay but she left me with the files, returning to her desk.

Once she'd gone, more questions circled my mind, each one more unsettling than the last. As much as I wanted to believe that everything could just go back to normal, that I could focus on Emmie and our future together and forget about all of this—I knew deep down that nothing would ever be the same. Not after I'd just seen her with another man. Not until I saw the rest of the video. Not until I found out the truth.

All of it.

Afterword

Thank you for joining me on the start of this hotpast journey with Ryan and Emmie. As we've followed Ryan's struggle with his insecurities, the secrets lurking in their past, and the heated emotions swirling between them, we've only begun to uncover the truth of what really happened during their year apart. Who sent the video to Ryan, and why? What is the deeper truth behind Emmie's past, and how will it affect their future together?

I know I left the book on a cliffhanger, but fear not. The next book in this story is already well underway, and it promises even more twists, drama, and steamy moments as Ryan delves deeper into the mystery and uncovers even more about Emmie's past. The questions we end with here will soon find their answers—but as always, those answers may lead to even more questions.

Stay tuned, as the next part of their journey is coming your way very soon. Thanks again for being here, and for following along with Ryan and Emmie's story. I can't wait to share what happens next!

About The Author

Paul Garland is an author of erotic novels and short stories, guaranteed to keep you turning the lust-filled pages until the early hours of the night. He lives with his wife and two children in a small house in the suburbs of Sheffield, England along with a lazy green budgerigar, an African Grey parrot that curses and a tubby tabby cat which would love to eat either. (Preferably the vulgar-tongued parrot.)

He has been writing since the turn of the millennium but only turned to the erotica genre in 2018 with his *Cerulean Erotica Presents* series and *No Angels* series of books which rapidly gained him a following. In 2020, he began '*The Cuckold Collection*,' a brand new collection of cuckold-themed books and two new series of shorter stories: *The No Angels Stories*, *The Sexy Season Stories* and *The Cerulean Archives*. 2022 began two series, *Holiday Hotwives* and *A Size Queen Story* and 2023 introduced a new series, *Improper Investigations* and the return to the *Cerulean Archives* with *I Found A Box Of Photos Of My Wife... And Her Ex*. 2024 sees another new series along with continuations of his current running series, the *My Wife* series and the return of *The Detective Hotwife*.

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